



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Palm Beach Christian Academies
School Website: <https://www.pbchristianacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Palm Beach Christian Academy (PBCA) presents itself as a robust example of a Classical Christian school operating across multiple Palm Beach County campuses, including Downtown West Palm Beach (33401). Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a Classical Trivium-based framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) integrated with a distinctly Christian, Scripture-centered worldview. Evidence across PBCA's site highlights Great Books, Socratic dialogue, memory work, and rhetoric training, alongside explicit statements of Christ-centered instruction, Scripture as a central anchor, and virtue/character formation. The public materials also articulate a strong sense of community and partnership with families, highlight faculty as visible leaders (team pages, campus principals, teachers), and present a multi-campus network that emphasizes shared mission and parental engagement.

Based on the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric, PBCA demonstrates clear alignment with Classical education in all six categories (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community). Category-by-category keyword analyses show strong presence of Positive Indicators (e.g., Christ-centered, Scripture, virtue, Great Books, Trivium, Socratic dialogue, dialectical reasoning, memory, rhetoric, wonder) and minimal to no explicit Negative Indicators in the available public-facing content. In aggregate, PBCA is classified as CLASSICAL with no category requiring a downgrade to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Distinctively Christian; Scripture-centered instruction; weekly chapel; theology references; partnership with church context.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: Christ-centered, Scripture, theology, biblical truth, weekly chapel, virtue terms. Negative: None detected in public materials.
- Why this rating: The site foregrounds Christian formation as a core, trans-empirical anchor (Christ, Scripture, biblical truth) with theological integration evident in interdisciplinary contexts.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on virtue/character formation, pursuit of truth; formation over mere information; integration of truth, goodness, beauty; Great Books and Great Conversation language appears in historical content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: Virtue/character formation, truth, goodness, beauty, Great Books, Great Conversation, formation over information. Negative: None detected.

- Why this rating: PBCA consistently ties education to virtue, wisdom, and formation in a Christian framework, aligning with the classical aim of forming humane, wise persons rather than solely preparing for work.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit Trivium model; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; integration of literature, history, theology; primary sources; discovery of truth, beauty, wisdom; memory and language development in early grades.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Socratic dialogue, primary sources, integration of literature/history/theology, memory/wonder. Negative: None detected.
- Why this rating: Curriculum centers on grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, frequent use of Socratic dialogue, and engagement with great books and primary sources, hallmark features of classical curriculum.
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower-school emphasis on memory, chant/singing as memory aids; upper-school Socratic discussions, seminars, debates; upper-level rhetoric training; integrated logic and rhetoric; dialectical reasoning.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, rhetoric, memory/chants, wonder. Negative: None detected in public materials.
- Why this rating: Pedagogical approach aligns with classical expectations (contemplation, memory, wonder in early years; Socratic discourse and rhetoric in later years). The site explicitly describes integrated logic and rhetoric and dialectical reasoning.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public-facing staff pages highlight named faculty (e.g., Principals, teachers, coordinators) and “Your Partners In A Superior Education” framing; team portraits; faculty as key public representation of the school’s values.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: living curriculum-like leadership presence, mentorship, faculty as core to the school’s mission; presence of multiple campus principals/teachers. Negative: None detected.
- Why this rating: The faculty are foregrounded as central figures in the school’s mission and programs, aligning with the classical emphasis on virtuous, capable teachers who model character and intellect.
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Distinctively Community language; partners with parents; emphasis on parent-teacher-student partnership; opportunities for family involvement; emphasis on family visits and multiple campuses; “Bridges” program shows a family-centered, parish-connected model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive: Parents as partners, community, co-educators/engagement, family involvement, campus visits. Negative: None detected.
- Why this rating: The site positions parents as integral partners with schools and churches, consistent with classical expectations of a shared mission with family involvement.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

PBCA demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across all six categories, anchored by a clearly Christian orientation. The site repeatedly emphasizes the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Socratic dialogue, virtue/character formation, and a robust community/family involvement model. Evidence of theology/scripture integration and liturgical-like communal practices further anchors the metaphysical foundation. The aggregate result is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable in this case, as the school is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories. No category requires a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL downgrade, and no needle-moving changes are required to achieve a CLASSICAL rating.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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